difficult to comprehend. Often Sorabji made appointments based on this sixth sense and this intuitive justification could hardly be explained by a written report which no doubt the Board expected. It is also here that the difference between a pioneer and a manager comes into sharp focus.

There were fears that Sorabji would start a new bank, an ‘opposition shop’ as Sir Phiroze Sethna called it. Nanporia says that this was a strange fear for those who had been denigrating his abilities as a banker. It ‘was a compliment that ill accorded with the complaints of inefficiency and worse that had been directed against him.’[21] According to Nanporia, F.E. Dinshaw’s realistic assessment put things in their proper perspective. Dinshaw said that the Central Bank would collapse if Sorabji left, and that if Masani’s resignation was not accepted, Sorabji would in all probability start a rival organization. Faced with this choice, the Board had no option but to backtrack. The opposition to Sorabji evaporated into thin air almost overnight, giving credence to the view that the problem had all along been one of personality clashes, preconceptions, and psychological incompatibilities. The inquiries were shelved with the facile explanation that an investigation would damage the bank’s reputation. In truth, the Board must have realized that even more damaging to the bank’s reputation would have been an inquiry which revealed no wrongdoing, as opposed to one which exposed irregularities. At the end of it all, Sorabji emerged triumphant and continued as the Managing Director.

Also, Masani and Sorabji were two very different people. Temperamentally they were poles apart. Masani was a skillful administrator but was no pioneer. Sorabji on the other hand was the rugged innovator who regarded consolidation as a preliminary to further expansion. There would have been a personality clash even in the most favourable circumstances; and since the circumstances were far from favourable, it was no surprise that mutual antipathy developed. As Nanporia observes, ‘Personal acerbities and motivations and irreconcilable temperaments were collectively a factor in intensifying a crisis the makings of which were inherent in the logic of the Central’s rapid expansion.’[22] He adds, ‘Tempers were lost and many wounding things said over which it would be pointless to linger.’[23]

But there was a happy ending for both Sorabji and the Central Bank. Sorabji’s services to banking were recognized by the government in June